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Lecture: Research

On October 12, 2006, Cathy Campbell, a librarian at Sherrod Library, came to Student In University to talk about how to research. The presentation involved Mrs. Campbell speaking to the class about how to search for articles within a database, and how to limit your search to find information within scholarly journals.

During the course of the presentation, she discussed where to find information within the Sherrod Library database of articles. While some databases only have portions of an article, other databases have the entire article from which to gather information. For the articles that are not complete, it is possible to receive the entire article through the interlibrary loan system, as well as any books that ETSU may not have within its libraries.

The best thing that I learned was that many technology related books are available online for free via Safari Tech Books Online, which is helpful in keeping an edge on current technology. I also liked that many databases attempt to make a citation, although editing the output is necessary most of the time.

The presentation was very well done, and I enjoyed learning about how to take a broad topic, narrow it down, and cipher information from credible sources. One improvement would be to allow more time for questions. With the broad topic of research, questions are sure to arise. It is important for each individual to understand the topic of research, as it will be encountered many times throughout one's college career. Another improvement would be to involve the students more with a proactive approach, instead of students reacting with questions at the end of the presentation. The presentation helped me and I appreciate Mrs. Campbell for taking the time out of her schedule to help us succeed in our college career.